

AI for All Minds — Faculty One-Pager

Rowan-Cabarrus Summer Institute · Josh Penzell · Imagination Applied

The Core Principle

Curb-cut effect: when you design for the margins — students who learn, process, or perceive differently — you improve the experience for the center. Captions, chunked content, and multi-modal materials were built for a few and are now used by most.

Three Lenses for Every Slide, Handout & Assignment

Chunked & Scannable	Short paragraphs, clear headings, bullets. Reduces cognitive load for ADHD, dyslexia, ESL, and tired students.
Multi-Modal	Pair text with audio, diagrams, demos, or examples. Reaches aphantasic, low-vision, and visual-spatial thinkers.
Plain Language	8th-grade reading level by default. Removes jargon, not rigor. Helps first-gen and ESL students.

Four Monday-Morning Prompts

1. Rewrite my learning outcomes for accessibility

Here are my course learning outcomes: [paste]. Rewrite each one with concrete observable verbs, three ways a student could demonstrate it (written/oral/applied), no jargon, plus one sentence on why it matters in the real world.

2. Generate misconception-targeted quiz questions

Topic: [paste]. My students consistently misunderstand: [paste]. Write 5 multiple-choice questions where each **WRONG** answer reflects a real misconception, the correct answer requires application, and include a 1-sentence explanation for each.

3. Make this assignment AI-resistant (and better)

Here is my assignment: [paste]. Redesign it so process is graded (drafts, reflections, peer feedback), students defend reasoning verbally or in 60-sec video, it connects to local context, and a student using AI to do it all would fail — but using AI as a tutor would thrive.

4. Be my struggling student

Act as a first-gen community college student in my [course]. ESL, working 30 hours/week. I'm about to teach: [paste]. Ask the **THREE** questions you'd most likely get stuck on, in order. Then tell me which part of how I'd probably explain it would lose you.

AI as Cognitive Accommodation

- **ADHD students** → AI as focus partner / planning coach
- **ESL students** → AI as translator + glossary
- **Dyslexic students** → AI as reformatter (lists, line spacing)
- **Aphantasic students** → AI to generate visuals from descriptions
- **Autistic students** → AI as social-cue interpreter for emails & feedback

One Thing to Try This Week

Pick **ONE** assignment, slide, or handout. Run it through one of the prompts above. Compare. Notice what you'd never have written yourself. That's the gap your students were already navigating.

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Built on Universal Design for Learning principles. Practices what it teaches.